



Single-use Plastic-free Policy



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Scope

This Policy applies to:

- All Coforge Limited offices, campuses, and operational sites across India, including all subsidiaries in India.
- All employees, contract staff, vendors, facility management teams, cafeteria partners, and on-site service providers operating within Coforge premises.
- All procurement of packaging, office supplies, pantry/cafeteria items, promotional materials, and catering items that may contain single-use plastics.
- All events and corporate activities organized by Coforge within Coforge premises (excluding events only sponsored by Coforge where operational control is not with Coforge).
- All waste handling and disposal managed internally or through external partners (external waste partners must comply with SUP-free requirements).

Operational Control & Third-Party Locations:

- This Policy is applicable within Coforge premises/boundary and where Coforge has operational control.
- At client sites or third-party venues, Coforge teams shall follow the intent of this Policy to the extent feasible, while complying with client/venue rules.

Purpose

Coforge recognizes that single-use plastics (SUPs)—such as disposable bags, cups, containers, cutlery, and packaging—create environmental risks due to persistent waste and leakage into land and water bodies. This Policy establishes Coforge’s commitment to reduce SUPs at source, enable reuse, and transition to responsible alternatives across operations in India.

Definitions

- Single-Use Plastic (SUP): Any plastic item designed to be used once (or for a very short period) before disposal (e.g., cutlery, cups, straws, stirrers, polystyrene foodware, balloon sticks, thin carry bags, shrink wrap used for internal logistics).
- Reusable: Durable items intended for multiple uses (e.g., metal cutlery, ceramic/glass cups, refillable dispensers).
- Recyclable: Products that can be recycled by available local recycling systems.
- Compostable: Products that can be composted in available local composting systems (where such systems exist).
- Event: Any planned gathering organized by Coforge within Coforge premises (meetings, workshops, celebrations, conferences, programs).
- Reuse-First: Reusable items are the default; disposables are permitted only under an approved exemption.

Roles & Responsibilities

- Executive Leadership Team: Approves the Policy and reviews progress against targets.
- Sustainability / ESG Team: Defines standards, consolidates metrics, and supports reporting in Sustainability disclosures (BRSR/GRI, as applicable).
- Facilities / Administration (Policy Owner): Implements site SOPs, vendor controls, signage/awareness, and periodic compliance checks; maintains evidence and reports performance.

- Procurement: Embeds SUP-free and packaging requirements in contracts/POs and monitors supplier compliance.
- Legal & Compliance: Tracks India regulatory requirements and State/UT directions and advises on obligations and risks.
- HR & L&D: Delivers awareness/training and promotes employee participation.
- Employees / Contractors / On-site Service Providers: Follow the Policy, use reusables/approved alternatives, and segregate waste correctly.

Goal

Coforge commits to progressively eliminating single-use plastics across all India sites by prohibiting the use, distribution, sale, and procurement of identified SUP items within Coforge premises, except where legally required or operationally unavoidable under an approved exemption.

This will be achieved through:

- Elimination at source (avoid SUP introduction into operations).
- Supplier transition to sustainable alternatives with appropriate accreditations/claims.
- Circularity in operations by prioritizing reuse and responsible material management.

Exemptions/Waiver

- Any exception must be justified (e.g., health/safety, statutory/packaging constraints, no viable alternative available locally).
- Exceptions require written approval by the Site Admin Head and Sustainability/ESG.
- All exemptions must be time-bound (validity defined).
- Exemptions shall be reviewed quarterly to enable substitution at the earliest opportunity.

Goal

Elimination & Substitution (Mandatory Prohibition)

The purchase, use, distribution, and sale of the following SUP items is prohibited within Coforge premises (unless approved under exemption):

- Plastic cutlery (fork/spoon/knife)
- Plastic plates, cups, and glasses
- Straws and stirrers
- Thermocol / EPS decorations and foodware
- Plastic wrapping / packing films used for internal operations
- Plastic carry bags below the minimum thickness prescribed under applicable Central/State rules (whichever is stricter)

Replacement rule: Reusables are the first preference; where reuse is not feasible, only locally recyclable or compostable alternatives may be used.

Design for Reuse

- Standardize reusable serveware across cafeterias, pantries, meetings and events (mugs, bottles, plates, cutlery).
- Promote refill stations/dispensers to displace bottled water at sites.

Regulatory Compliance (India)

Coforge shall meet or exceed applicable requirements under the Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016 (as amended) and any stricter State/UT directions, including source segregation and responsible handover to authorized waste handlers.

Supplier Engagement & Contract Controls (including EPR where applicable)

- Embed SUP-free requirements (and packaging reduction/take-back where feasible) into relevant supplier contracts and purchase orders.
- Suppliers and service partners shall support transition to plastic-free/sustainable alternatives and reduced packaging.

Waste Minimization & Segregation

- Segregate waste at source into wet, dry, and reject streams at all sites.
- Maintain separate collection systems for plastic waste where generated.
- Train housekeeping and relevant staff for correct segregation and handling.

Transparency & Continual Improvement

SUP reduction progress and metrics shall be consolidated for annual reporting in Coforge sustainability disclosures and used to drive continual improvement in site practices.

Targets & KPIs (India – All Sites)

Targets

- 100% elimination of Policy-prohibited SUP items across all Coforge India sites by Dec 2026.
- 100% reuse/recycle-first cafeterias/pantries by Dec 2026 (exceptions only through waiver).
- Plastic Bottle-free internal meetings/events (refill stations/jugs) at all sites by Dec 2026.
- 100% new/renewed vendor contracts to include SUP-free clauses by Dec 2026.
- ≥90% segregation accuracy at major sites by Sept 2026.

Monitoring & Reporting

- Facilities/Admin shall conduct quarterly compliance checks at sites (cafeteria/pantry, stores, housekeeping, events).
- Findings and corrective actions shall be tracked; repeated vendor non-compliance may trigger contractual action.
- Sustainability/ESG consolidates site data for annual disclosures and internal review.

Annexure A: Prohibited Single-Use Plastic Items (India – Coforge Premises)

The following items are prohibited within Coforge premises (subject to approved exemptions/waivers). Site teams may add stricter items based on State/UT directions and operational context.

A1. Food & Beverage Service (Cafeteria/Pantry/Events)

- ◆ Plastic cutlery (forks, spoons, knives) and plastic stirrers.
- ◆ Plastic plates, bowls, cups, glasses, and food containers (including polystyrene/thermocool foodware).
- ◆ Plastic straws.
- ◆ Disposable plastic portion cups, lids, sachet-based dispensers (where reusable dispensers are feasible).

A2. Packaging, Wrapping & Carry Bags

- ◆ Plastic carry bags below the minimum thickness prescribed under applicable Central/State rules (whichever is stricter).
- ◆ Plastic wrapping/shrink wrap/packing films used for internal logistics where alternatives are feasible.
- ◆ Plastic flags/banners/thermocool decorative items for events.

A3. Office & Miscellaneous Disposables

- ◆ Single-use plastic folders, trays, and similar disposable plastic stationery where reusable options exist.
- ◆ Single-use PET water bottles for meetings/events within premises (to be replaced by refill/jugs, subject to exception).

Note: Where a prohibited item is legally mandated or unavoidable for health/safety or statutory reasons, an exemption/waiver must be approved as per Section 6.

Approved by:

John Speight

President, Executive Director



About Coforge

Coforge is a global digital services and solutions provider, that leverages emerging technologies and deep domain expertise to deliver real-world business impact for its clients. A focus on very select industries, a detailed understanding of the underlying processes of those industries and partnerships with leading platforms provides us a distinct perspective. Coforge leads with its product engineering approach and leverages Cloud, Data, Integration and Automation technologies to transform client businesses into intelligent, high growth enterprises. Coforge's proprietary platforms power critical business processes across its core verticals. The firm has a presence in 21 countries with 26 delivery centers across nine countries.

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